Headlines read: *Meg Markle's father a con artist! Staged candid photos for money!*

A week before the wedding, this now became *the* story.

Though the photos had been taken weeks before, they'd been held in reserve until the most devastating possible moment.

Soon after the story broke, Thomas Markle sent us a text:

I'm so ashamed.

We phoned him.

And texted him.

And phoned again.

We're not angry, please pick up.

He didn't answer.

Then we heard, along with the rest of the world, that he'd apparently had a heart attack and wasn't coming to the wedding.

46.

THE NEXT DAY Meg had a text from Kate.

There was a problem with the dresses for the bridesmaids, apparently. They needed altering. The dresses were French couture, hand-sewn from measurements only. So it wasn't a big shock that they might need altering.

Meg didn't reply to Kate straightaway. Yes, she had endless wedding-related texts, but mostly she was dealing with the chaos surrounding her father. So the next morning she texted Kate that our tailor was standing by. At the Palace. His name was Ajay.

This wasn't sufficient.

They set up a time to speak that afternoon

Charlotte's dress is too big, too long, too baggy. She cried when she tried it on at home, Kate said.

Right, and I told you the tailor has been standing by since eight a.m. Here. At KP. Can you take Charlotte to have it altered, as the other moms are doing?

No, all the dresses need to be remade.